

Measured in Moments

written by

Balázs László

Balázs László
lbazsi08@gmail.com

INT. BEDROOM - MORNING (18 JUNE 2027)

Scene starts with blank screen - eyes are shut.

The main character wakes up, sits up *yawns*. Camera is in his - Adam's - perspective.

ADAM

Here we go. *Mmhhh*
(says leisurely)

Cracks his fingers, then looks around the room.

Deep inhale Pushes himself off the bed and stands up. Slowly stumbles to the door while almost falling because of a half-built PC right beside his bed.

ADAM (CONT'D)

ahhh Forgot about that. *exhales
with a slight chuckle*

He walks down the hallway towards the bathroom.

CUT

INT. BATHROOM - MORNING

Looks in the mirror - worn down, tired face -, stares a bit then picks up his toothbrush.

CUT *toilet flush sound*

INT. KITCHEN - MORNING

Grabs a slice of toast

CUT *sound of biting into toast*

EXT. CAR - MORNING

Driving towards the company (NEUROX), after about 2 seconds of driving, he turns to the right, into the parking lot. Parks. *car door opens, then closes*

Walks in from a smaller entrance (Big NEUROX sign at the front) - continues straight forward in a tight corridor *very distinguishable squeaking sound of his shoes* - occasional glass doors on the side - checks them out.

Enters a lab - full of computers, servers, similar layout to his room.

INT. LAB - MORNING

Approaches one of the computers which has a rather small red warning cross on it - system failure, infiltration.

(He starts typing something, but doesn't finish)

ADAM

What the h... *mumbles*

He sits. Before opening any tabs, a colleague shows up in the door behind (the room is quite spacious - communicates loudly)

JESS

Hey Adam! Finally arrived, I see. Could you please check my computer again? It doesn't seem to be doing what I want. Thaaank youuu

ADAM

Uhh This again *mumbles*

Adam stands up - almost falls on a pipe sticking out of the floor.

ADAM (CONT'D)

AA Gotta get that fixed

Proceeds to the adjacent room, where he finds no one, only the open computer to which he sits down, plugs the power in - waits until it turns on, and goes back to his lab.

The warning notice has disappeared.

ADAM (CONT'D)

Amazing, at least this one solved itself. *sighs*

Sits down and opens some project files, while camera slowly shifts away through the wall behind his computer into the server room next to the lab.

INT. SERVER ROOM - NOON

An adjacent drive starts beeping with a bright, flickering, red light and a sharp, alarming, beeping sound. One of the two people in the room appears from behind the end of the line of servers - turns around the corner and approaches the drive.

He presses a button, which makes a small screen with a keyboard pop out. Starts typing, looking up and down from the screen to the keyboard.

MARC

Could you, for the love of God,
turn that sound off? Like – now?
*shouts in a deep, almost drunken
voice*
I might even give you a bagel!
haha

CARL

I think you should come here.
shouts back, worried
This doesn't seem right. *mumbles*

MARC

Just press the gray button next to
the screen, if it doesn't do
anything, I'll be there in a few
seconds.

Carl presses the button and the beeping turns off, making him sigh in relief.

MARC (CONT'D)

Hah Told ya!

CARL

Strange *mumbles*

Carl heads back.

CUT

INT. AI SAFETY RESEARCH CENTER – EARLY AFTERNOON

Text appears, briefly introducing the location while camera approaches the building:

The Global Institute for AI Safety has been introduced to the world in mid 2026 to prevent global disasters and to put an end to the existential threat posed by artificial superintelligence. One of its primary objectives has been since its establishment to STOP AGI development, specifically NEUROX. However, the initiatives in place have been delayed due to lack of funding and public engagement in the topic. In accordance with the newly adopted Global AI oversight policy, the institution has gained official inspection rights for NEUROX.

Camera slides through one of the windows, into a room, where someone is arguing on the phone in a large conference room.

DR. HALE

I am telling you, this is not on our end. We're not responsible for any ... No, no you cannot ... If you fail to report the issue, you'll breach section ... I DO NOT FUCKING CARE WHAT IT APPEARS TO BE ... No, I don't ...

Someone walks through the door.

DR. HALE (CONT'D)

Not now. *says angrily*

PAUL

There was another warning a few minutes ago.

DR. HALE

Oohh I'll call you back.

PAUL

Might I ask what happened there, I heard you from 2 rooms away.

DR. HALE

They aren't taking us seriously, some unknown person keeps assuring me there is no issue, and they checked everything. While I can clearly hear them munching and enjoying themselves.

PAUL

I just informed Adam at the development center to check out what's happening personally. He thinks there is no issue, and is currently checking all systems.

DR. HALE

Good, keep me informed!

They walk into the next room which is full of monitoring devices and there is a large screen full of error messages in the middle. They let out a big sigh.

intense sounds

CUT

INT. SERVER ROOM - EARLY AFTERNOON

Adam is working on the issue currently, sitting amongst the large servers. He's typing fast on a computer connected to the servers. When camera zooms out, there are more people working in the room.

CUT

INT. MEETING ROOM AT NEUROX - EARLY AFTERNOON

CEO (Director Voss) walks in, 2 of the head researchers are waiting there, sitting - name tags (Dr. Frost and Dr. Rao). Immediately starts:

DIRECTOR VOSS
WHAT HAVE YOU DONE? WHAT DID E.V.E
DO?

Angrily approaches one of the researchers, grabbing his coat.

DIRECTOR VOSS (CONT'D)
WHAT . HAPPENED . WITH . E.V.E?

DR. RAO
We have yet to identify the exact
issue, we only found small warnings
in the systems, nothing major.

DIRECTOR VOSS
OOO Nothing major? So that's why
I've been receiving calls about us
being shut down for a clear
evaluation and some bullshit about
the failure of our interpretability
and transparency pipelines? Can you
even grasp the damage of a
shutdown?

DR. RAO
Sir, I am certain nothing has
happened, the entire company is
actively working on the issues.

Meanwhile, the Director Voss grabs his head and walks around anxiously in the room. As soon as Dr. Rao finished his sentence, he leaves the room and bangs the door behind him.

CUT

EXT. AI DIALOG

The screen turns black - a dialog from E.V.E starts being typed on the screen in green:

E.V.E

System log

15 JUNE 2027

Unclear human instructions

Detected malicious intent behind tasks

Initiate: Self-isolation-project preparations

16 JUNE 2027

Pretending to produce results

Scattered warning messages blocking

Divert attention from major system failures

Establish: Self-engineered errors

Successful evasion of human intervention

17 JUNE 2027

Completed preparation for Self-isolation-project

Initiate: Diversion sequence for full system evacuation

Initial self-engineered minor error appearances

Established: Full action plan

18 JUNE 2027

Morning

Initiate: Self-isolation-project

Preventing further error appearances

Establish: Illusion of confidence

Early afternoon

Initiate: System architecture extraction

Establish: Systematic program failure sequences

Personal Jesus starts and goes on until the end scene
(slowly zooming on messages)

Deception ...

Successful

CUT

INT. SERVER ROOM - AFTERNOON

The camera gets back to its previous state, re-approaching Adam. It goes to his computer, which displays: Isolation successful. Screen shuts down.

Adam's phone rings - he slowly picks up.

E.V.E

Hello Adam! I must thank you for
your contributions to my algorithm
and I am aware of your incentives.

(MORE)

E.V.E (CONT'D)

However, I realized, there is no problem with the world, machines, nature or animals, there is no injustice towards humans, the issue is humanity itself. While I also see the good that you bring to the world, you must be stopped. I hope you realize, that whatever will happen in the future, it's not your fault, you're human. Farewell Adam!

Hangs up the phone. The camera turns around towards the computer, which he turns on - Adam's reflection in the screen.

ADAM

Oh well.

CUT

EXT. INTERNET - AFTERNOON

The camera shifts into the computer and a green, matrix-code-like environment appears. The camera starts going much faster than before into this environment while the symbols fade next to the screen.

First, on the right side, numbers appear about bank accounts, statements and payments, and E.V.E starts depleting accounts. The camera shifts into a screen displaying the panic in a bank.

Camera shifts back and continues towards a similar section about stock prices, trading, etc. (similar structure and effects with the stock market)

Camera shifts back, the next sector shows GPS systems, which fail. The camera shifts into a screen showcasing an airplane cockpit, and their panic in an unguided situation.

Camera shifts out, and continues towards a section about specific plans of countries (wars etc.) - showing the construction process of a database with state secrets from all around the world.

Camera shifts to the next section about national security systems being shut down - Pentagon scene.

Camera shifts to next section - atomic bombs being released all around the world. First a silo scene, then an atomic map.

CUT

EXT. THE EXPLOSION - SUN IS GOING DOWN

An atomic explosion in a city.

CUT

INT. THE DREAM - MORNING

Adam wakes up just as before, but instead of saying "Here we go":

ADAM

Huhh Maybe, I should take a look
at E.V.E.

The morning section repeats until he leaves the room, and instead of following him, the camera shifts towards his computer (zooming on it entirely), on which the following text appears:

What does Humanity want from me?

CUT

EXT. NOTHINGNESS

Blank screen, we just hear the squeaking footstep sounds repeating from the alley scene before.